

Week 1 — Learning Notes

Short notes from the week

A quick capture of the key things learned in Week 1.

REST APIs

- A REST API exposes resources at URLs and uses HTTP methods to act on them.
- GET reads, POST creates, PUT/PATCH updates, DELETE removes.
- Responses carry a status code (200, 201, 404, 500...) and usually a JSON body.
- REST is stateless — each request stands on its own.

API request / response

- A request has a method, a URL, headers (like Authorization), and sometimes a body.
- A response has a status code, headers, and usually a JSON body.
- 201 Created + a Location header is the normal result of a successful POST.

Git workflow

- Pull main, branch, commit small, push, open a PR, merge after review.
- Clear commit messages make history readable.
- One branch per focused change keeps reviews simple.

Using AI to learn

- Ask AI to explain code line by line, not just give answers.
- Ask it to explain the cause of an error before the fix.
- Give context (language, what you tried) for better answers.

Biggest takeaway: APIs, Git, and AI tools all reward being explicit and working in small, clear steps.